

METHODOLOGY_LOG

The Breadcrumb Trail — Methodology Log

Inception 2026-09-21. Opened at inception per the rule, before any work exists.

Zone: V · **Vault:** Zone V, nested inside the Zone P vault — separable, and still contained **Status:** inception. The form exists (it is 00_MIND/plans/V4.0 PUNCH LIST.md); the product does not.

What it is

A way of writing a long trail of tasks so that a person who doesn't understand the implications of any of them can still walk it. Born 2026-09-21 from his complaint about his own punch list: *"Each carries a task forcing me to make choices I don't understand the implications of. Step 1 has several by itself and I have no idea how each impacts Step 2."*

The form — the method, and it is his

Every task is **one action**. If the action contains a choice, the choice is **named**, the options are **listed**, the **default** is marked (the smallest correct one — v7), and **what it does to the next step** is written out. Every task ends with **Lost?** → the one page to open, and **Done when** — the paper in your hand. Tasks run strictly in order; task N needs only N-1; stopping at any task costs nothing below it. Anything not needed yet is a **gate** with the one condition that opens it, kept off the page.

Why it's a product

His hint, same day: a competency-based university's students carry on the order of ~4,000 tasks from enrollment to graduation, academic competencies included, and would want a vivid trail, cradle to grave. The form above is domain-agnostic — it was written for filing an LLC and a nonprofit, and it works unchanged for a degree plan, a licence, a move, a case. **The method travels; no institution's content ever does.**

Boundary — read this before any Zone I work

- **Zone I entered the picture on 09-21 by his own hint.** If this form is ever built *for* his employer, that is Zone I work, done on Zone I equipment and time, and the artifact belongs to the employer — the drawbridge, $P \rightarrow I$, with the register entry prepared. Nothing from that build comes back here.
- **What stays his regardless:** this method — the form itself — deposited as method (a copyright packet, alongside the working discipline), with the institution and every student task stripped out. Strip the domain out and whatever still stands is his.
- **What this root never holds:** any student's task list, any course's competency map, any employer document, or the fact of where he works.

Next correct right move

His: say whether this is (a) a Zone V product first (a trail-writing kit sold like the *Joshua Says* books), (b) a Zone I proposal (his employer's, through the drawbridge), or (c) both in that order — the default here is **(c)**: deposit the method as his, then propose. Nothing built until he says.

Fail-forwards

1. (*open*)

Boundary abutments

Abuts	At what edge	What may cross	What never crosses
Zone P — parent	the form was born in 00_MIND/plans/	the method downward; this root’s status upward	personal filings as product content
Zone I	the drawbridge, if he opens it	a proposal, operator-carried, method only	any institutional task, competency map, or data; anything back
10_Armored_Training	the same publishing channel	the <i>Joshua Says</i> form and price	one root’s obligations into another’s
30_Copyright	the method deposit	the form, as method	any domain content